A CASE STUDY · FOR MEDTECH INDUSTRY ASSOCIATES & HR STAFF

Closing the MedTech Skill Gap in India

How a gap-first, competency-based training framework built the certificate India's medical device industry trusts

2020	**50+**	**5,000+**
Year AptSkill was founded	Registered industry trainers	Learners trained across the globe

Authored by Andrew McLean, MedTech Executive Leader with Over Two Decades of Experience · September 2026

Executive Summary

India's medical device industry has scaled quickly — but the talent pipeline hasn't kept pace.

Engineers and life-science graduates enter regulatory and quality roles with strong technical foundations, yet little practical exposure to the frameworks that govern the industry day to day: ISO 13485, EU MDR, FDA 21 CFR, sterilization validation, design controls, and CAPA systems.

AptSkill MedTech was founded in 2020 to close that gap directly — not with a content library, but with a competency-based training framework designed backward from the skills each role actually demands, delivered by 50+ practicing industry trainers, and tested through scenario-based assessment modeled on exams like RAC.

This paper looks at the nature of that skill gap, the design principles behind AptSkill's gap-first framework, and the mechanisms — trainer network, course architecture, and assessment design — that let the model scale without diluting the depth of any single competency.

THE RESULT

A certificate hiring managers treat as a genuine signal of job readiness — not just course completion.

- 5,000+ learners trained across India's MedTech industry
- 50+ practicing trainers building every course
- Courses designed backward from real job competencies

A Fast-Scaling Industry, an Unfinished Pipeline

India's medical device sector keeps drawing in strong engineering and life-science talent. But regulatory and quality affairs — the functions that decide whether a device legally reaches the market — demand a different kind of competency than most degree programs provide.

Universities taught theory, if at all

Standards like ISO 13485, EU MDR, and FDA 21 CFR were rarely more than optional reading.

Companies needed practitioners

Teams needed people who could apply that theory under the pressure of a live audit or a submission deadline.

Almost nothing bridged the two

Unlike pharma or IT, MedTech had no established training pathway connecting classroom theory to job-ready practice.

“The gap was never a matter of intelligence or effort. It was structural.”

The structural nature of the gap is why a conventional course library was never going to close it — it needed a framework built around real job competencies.

The Cost of the Gap

That structural gap showed up in concrete, expensive ways across the industry.

Failed or flagged audits

Documentation and process gaps that new hires simply hadn't been trained to recognize.

Delayed submissions

Teams learned frameworks like design controls and CAPA on the job, rather than before it.

Months-long onboarding

Extended ramp-up time before a new regulatory or quality hire could operate independently.

Aakash Jindal, a practicing MedTech regulatory consultant, saw this pattern repeatedly: teams that were regulatory-literate on paper but untested in practice. In 2020, he founded AptSkill to close the gap at the source — rather than working around it client by client.

From Content-First to Gap-First

Most training platforms start with a content-first question: what can we teach? AptSkill's course design begins with a harder one:

"What is the industry actually missing?"

Designing Backward From the Job

Before a single slide is written, every module must answer a precise question: what competency is it building? Spotting a documentation gap in an audit? Choosing the right corrective action for a CAPA? A module isn't allowed to exist until the answer is specific.

Granular, Testable Modules

A broad subject like sterilization validation isn't one overview — it's split into distinct, testable competencies: dry heat, liquid chemical, aseptic processing, and sterility testing.

QUALITY SYSTEMS CURRICULUM

1. Good Documentation Practices
2. Design Controls
3. Supplier & Production Controls
4. CAPA & Internal Audit
5. Management Review

Content Library vs. Skill-Based Framework

A content library teaches a learner about something. A skill-based framework proves a learner can do something.

Dimension	Content-First Model (Traditional EdTech)	Gap-First, Skill-Based Model (AptSkill)
Starting point	What's easy or interesting to teach	**The specific competency a role requires**
Module structure	Broad, subject-level (one “Sterilization” overview)	**Granular & competency-mapped (Dry Heat, Liquid Chemical, Aseptic, Sterility Testing)**
Assessment	Checks recall — can the learner remember it	**Checks application — can the learner act correctly in a realistic scenario**
Certificate	Signals attendance	**Signals demonstrated, tested competency**
Built by	Professional writers or generalist instructors	**50+ practicing regulatory & quality professionals**

Assessment: The Mechanism That Makes Competency Verifiable

AptSkill deliberately avoids recall quizzes and box-ticking completion certificates. Instead, learners face scenario-based practice tests and full-syllabus simulations modeled closely on how real certifications — including RAC — actually evaluate candidates.

THE TRAINER'S BAR

“Would a learner who only skimmed the material still be able to guess the answer? If so, the question isn't finished.”

WHAT THE ASSESSMENT ACTUALLY ASKS

- **Identify a documentation gap**
- **Flag a non-conformance**
- **Choose the correct corrective action**

This is also, according to AptSkill's own trainers, the main reason learners retain what they've learned well beyond the end of the course.

Built by Practitioners, Not Content Writers

50+

registered industry trainers, each bringing frontline experience from a different corner of the industry

Quality Systems · Sterilization · Design Controls · Regulatory Submissions

Trainers draw on live audit experience, real submission work, and direct client exposure to shape both content and assessment — rather than reading from a fixed script.

WHAT KEEPS THE NETWORK COHERENT

Skill-first design

Every module starts from a competency, not a topic.

Scenario-based assessment

Every test mirrors a realistic, applied situation.

No shortcuts

The same rigorous standard applies to every trainer and module.

A learner moving between modules experiences the same competency-based system at every step — regardless of which trainer built it.

A FOUNDER WHO NEVER LEFT THE WORK

Aakash Jindal

Founder, AptSkill MedTech · Practicing Regulatory Consultant

Jindal founded AptSkill in 2020 without stepping back from his own regulatory consulting practice. That proximity to live client work matters: when EU MDR guidance shifts, when an FDA inspection trend emerges, or when a real audit surfaces a gap that hasn't yet reached the textbooks — that knowledge flows directly into AptSkill's courses and assessments.

"It is the same dynamic that separates a teaching hospital from a textbook: proximity to the real work changes the quality of what gets taught."

What Course Developers Learn From the Framework

Subject-matter experts joining the trainer network usually assume deep domain knowledge is the hard part of teaching. AptSkill's review process pushes them toward a harder, more specific question:

> ***"If a learner finishes this module, what will they actually be able to do that they couldn't do before?"***

Gap-backward thinking, down to the slide

The same logic used at the framework level gets applied to every individual slide and assessment item.

Sharper practitioners, not just teachers

Writing a defensible scenario forces trainers to re-examine the edge cases in their own field.

Edge cases the textbook misses

The scenarios that rarely appear in a textbook but routinely appear in a live audit.

Outcomes: Learners & Employers

For Learners

- 5,000+ learners trained across India's MedTech regulatory and quality affairs industry
- Feedback centers on specific, applied moments — catching a real audit gap, feeling ready for a RAC exam
- A learning path from foundational quality systems through advanced RAC certification prep, without diluting depth

For Employers

- A certificate that functions as a hiring signal, reflecting assessment against job-relevant competencies
- Reduced onboarding uncertainty — candidates arrive tested against real regulatory and quality scenarios
- A growing base of industry collaborations keeping curriculum aligned with what employers are hiring for

Outcomes for the Industry

Five years after AptSkill's founding, the impact reflects a measurable narrowing of the structural skill gap that motivated the company's founding.

50+

Registered industry trainers

5,000+

Learners trained across the globe

5,000+

Member community engaged on LinkedIn

India's MedTech industry keeps scaling and its regulatory landscape keeps growing more complex — but the pipeline between university theory and job-ready practice is demonstrably less empty than it was five years ago.

The problem was never a lack of talent — it was the absence of a credible bridge to applied regulatory competency.

Gap-first design

Practitioner-built trainer network

Scenario-based assessment

That combination is why the AptSkill certificate has come to mean something specific to employers across India's MedTech industry: not exposure to a topic, but demonstrated, verified competency in it.

Advancing MedTech — One Course at a Time